

|| SHANTA ||

The peace, the quiet...

Through judicious and careful planning, metropolitans could be easily developed into 'garden cities' and help us do away with pollution and traffic woes in metros.

OPEN SPACES

India is on the path of rapid development and our cities are experiencing urban growth like never before. The most visible aspect of this is the proliferating constructional activities in almost every nook and corner — be it the mega malls on the high streets or the multi-storeyed apartments on the serpentine lanes of the metropolis. The city greenery is also receding at the same speed, if not at a higher rate. This is a serious issue, more so for public health, considering the symptoms of the much talked about global climatic change — rising pollution levels, soaring temperature and erratic behaviour of the natural cycle. Nature's renewability has been affected. Urban population is exposed to greater health risks — both physical and psychological.

Our metros are well endowed with natural resources like abundance of water-bodies, good soil, plenty of rainfall and a climate favourable for vegetation growth. Through judicious and careful planning, these metros could be easily developed into 'Garden cities'.

Open spaces including parks and gardens are essential components of any built environment and if effectively integrated with the city planning, can form an

organised 'open space structure' of a city where nature can be interwoven with urban life.

It is not just the openness of the area, but also the uninterrupted flow of vehicular traffic that surprises people when we compare British-era India with the congested thoroughfares today. It is also the 'land-use' that has an important stake in the city affairs and dictates a city's performance. Hence, if open spaces were injected into the crowded localities in adequate numbers and sizes, India would have been different.

Again, it is not the 'quantity' of open space alone; a lot has to do with the 'quality' as well. Hierarchy of open spaces from neighbourhood to local parks is not that scarce, but it is the look and feel of these spaces that negatively affect the images of the city.

Just some sound measures would make each built unit a self-sufficient and self-sustaining one where it is reusing and recycling resources and its generated wastes within its own premises. The need is just to wake up to the benefits of landscape, greenery and open spaces.



We don't believe in making sketches...

We make

*Elegant
Space*

right under the Sky



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